

ALINE-PRISCILLIA MESSI

PHD CANDIDATE
NYU PSYCHOLOGY

CONTACT

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Address: 10 Washington Pl., 6th Floor,
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EDUCATION

2022 – present
New York University
PhD Cognition and Perception, Psychology

2018 – 2021
Leiden University
B.A. in Linguistics, Cum Laude (GPA 8.5/10)

RESEARCH POSITIONS

2022 – present
New York University
PhD Candidate in Neuroscience of Language Group
Supervisor: Dr. Liina Pylikkanen

2020 – 2021
Max Planck Institute for Psycholinguistics
Research assistant in Language and Computation in Neural Systems Group
Honors thesis: "Gain shift in the nested hierarchies of language"
Supervisors: Dr. Yiya Chen (Leiden University) and Dr. Sanne ten Oever (Max Planck Institute for Psycholinguistics)

2020 – 2022
Semantic Universals in the Modal Domain (MODuni)
Data analyst for French data

March 2020 – August 2020
eLaw Center for Law and Digital Technologies
Research assistant for Law and Healthcare Robots Project (Marie Skłodowska-Curie Postdoctoral Research Grant)

April 2020 – July 2020
Max Planck Institute for Psycholinguistics
Research Intern in Language and Computation in Neural Systems Group

HONORS, AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS

Social Sector Leadership Diversity Fellow, New York University, 2023 – 2024
Travel Award, Society for the Neurobiology of Language, 2023
Engberg Award, Cognition and Perception, New York University, \$1000, 2022
ECHO Centre for Diversity Policy, ECHO Award Nominee Leiden University, 2021
Humanities Honors College, Leiden University, 2020–2021
Propaedeutic diploma in Linguistics with Summa Cum Laude, Leiden University, 2019

PUBLICATIONS

Messi, A., Bhuyain, A., & Pylkkänen, L. (submitted). **Temporal constraints on the neural signatures of narrative processing.**

Messi, A. & Pylkkänen, L. (2025). **Tracking neural correlates of contextualized meanings with representational similarity analysis.** Journal of Neuroscience, 45(19). DOI: 10.1523/JNEUROSCI.0409-24.2025

TEACHING

Summer 2026

Adjunct professor

Cognition

Fall 2025

Teaching Assistant

Cognitive Neuroscience

2023 – 2024

Course Assistant

Intro to Data Literacy, Lab in Developmental Psychology

July 2023

Instructor: Neuroscience Outreach Group at NYU x College Career Lab

Taught: Introduction to Neuroanatomy; Learning and Memory

TALKS, PRESENTATIONS

January 2026

Talk: The Influence of Structure and Speed on MEG Responses to Narratives

Alpine Brain Imaging Meeting, Champéry, Switzerland

November 2025

Talk: 4th Year Talk

Psychology Department, New York University

September 2025

Poster: Right Hemisphere Sensitivity to Structure and Speed

Authors: **Messi Aline-Priscillia**, Pylkkänen Liina

Society for the Neurobiology of Language, Washington D.C., USA

April 2025

Presentation: Representational Similarity Analysis

Neuroscience of Language Joint Methods meetings, New York University

November 2024

Panelist Pathways to a doctoral degree

GSAS Master's College and Wasserman Center, New York University

November 2023

Invited Talk: Tracking word representations in MEG using Representational Similarity Analysis.

NeuLab, New York University

October 2023

Poster: Tracking word representations in MEG using Representational Similarity Analysis.

Authors: **Messi Aline-Priscillia**, Pylkkänen Liina

Society for the Neurobiology of Language, Marseille, France

MENTORSHIP

June 2024 – September 2025

Abir Bhuyain

Junior – Language and Mind major (Pre-med) New York University

Former research assistant for dissertation project, now Lab Manager

November 2025 – present

Nadia Hoffman

Sophomore – Language and Mind major, New York University

Current research assistant for dissertation project

SERVICE AND OUTREACH

2024 – Fall 2025

Methods Meetings Co-Organizer

Neuroscience of Language Lab, New

York University

2023 – 2024

Cognition and Perception Social Chair

Psychology, New York University

June 2024 – present

Grant Coordinator

Bed-Stuy Clothes Swap

Summer 2023

Science on the Ballot Team Member

March for Science NYC

May 2023

Poster session Judge

27th Annual NYU Masters Psychology

Research Conference 2023

Summer 2022

Content Coordinator

Psychology Summer Research

Program, New York University

SKILLS

Software

Praat, SPSS, Microsoft Office Suite,
PsychoPy, Audacity, Eprime, Gorilla,
Qualtrics

Programming

Python, Matlab, R, basic HTML and
javascript

Marketing and Design

Illustrator, Sketch, Invision, Wordpress, SEO
optimization (Yoast), CRM, Google Ad Words

Languages

Native in French and English, Advanced
Spanish